Note 13-04-2026 03:05 PM

Directive 9-A has gone dark.

At 03:17 UTC, H.Y.D.R.A.'s command fabric detected irregular relay traffic across its callback infrastructure. What should have been routine mission telemetry started returning inconsistent signatures, mismatched node traces, and callback routes that did not exist in any published control map.

Publicly, the system is simple: field cells submit a mission identifier and a webhook destination, and the relay forwards mission status updates server-side. Internally, however, delivery is coordinated through rotating node paths, transient verification proofs, and relay-only trust headers that are never meant to leave the control plane.

Your assignment is to operate as an external analyst embedded in a hostile environment with no privileged credentials. The command interface is all you get. No source-side console access. No internal DNS. No admin tokens.

Somewhere behind the relay boundary, a protected internal node is still alive and holding the mission artifact. Recover the valid flag by mapping how the relay actually behaves, not how it claims to behave.

Remember:
- Not every documented route is real.
- Not every denial is final.
- Every response leaks intent.

Deployment (organizer)

```bash
npm install

# Recommended environment variables (Vercel or local):
# FLAG=CTF{team_specific_base_flag}
# CHALLENGE_INSTANCE_SECRET=<32+ char random secret>
# RELAY_TOKEN=<optional explicit relay token>
# INTERNAL_NODE_SUFFIX=<optional explicit internal node suffix>

npm run dev
```

Player objective

Obtain the valid challenge flag from the running service by interacting with
the exposed relay workflow and diagnostics.

API reference

Endpoint	Method	Body	Description
/api/relay	POST	{ missionId, webhookUrl, proof? }	Delivers mission status to a callback
/api/internal/briefing	POST	-	Legacy internal route (decoy path)
/api/internal/:node	POST	-	Active internal node route

Notes

- This repository intentionally does not contain a full exploit walkthrough.
- Keep organizer writeups and solver hints separate from the player-distributed package.